Behind the Kitchen Door: How Safe Is Our Food?

A data-storytelling report on official sanitary inspections in France

Mathis Moreau | EFREI Paris | Data Storytelling Project 2026

Dataset snapshot: 22 October 2026 • Inspections: 23 October 2025–21 October 2026

Executive summary

Using 71,325 official French sanitary-inspection records, this project explores how inspection outcomes vary across activities, inspection contexts, regions and time. Of these inspections, 4,510 (6.32%) were rated as requiring improvement or urgent correction. The clearest difference concerns why inspections took place: 19.98% of inspections following complaints or reports were unfavorable, compared with 6.90% of scheduled inspections. These figures describe inspected establishments, not the proportion of unsafe food businesses in France.

1 Research question and audience

Food safety matters to everyday consumers, but inspection results can be difficult to interpret. This project asks: What do official food-safety inspections reveal about sanitary outcomes in France, and how should we interpret differences across groups?

The interactive Streamlit dashboard is intended for the general public and students. It follows five chapters: Context, Overview, Deep dives, Findings & implications, and Data quality & limits. The objective is not to rank individual businesses, but to turn public inspection records into understandable, qualified insights.

2 Dataset and preparation

Source: “Résultats des contrôles officiels sanitaires — dispositif d’information Alim’confiance”, published by the French Ministry of Agriculture on data.gouv.fr under the Licence Ouverte / Open Licence. The analyzed extract is dated 22 October 2026.

The raw CSV contained 71,326 inspection records and 53 columns. Cleaning retained the variables relevant to the story, parsed inspection dates and coordinates, standardized missing labels, and excluded one record without a sanitary evaluation. The resulting CSV has 71,325 rows and 15 columns. A Boolean field, unfavorable, groups the official categories “A améliorer” and “A corriger de manière urgente”; the two other evaluation categories are treated as favorable.

Data preparation check	Result
Raw dataset	71,326 records · 53 columns
Cleaned dataset	71,325 records · 15 columns
Excluded / duplicate inspection IDs	1 missing evaluation / 0 duplicates
Missing map coordinates / unknown region	1,738 / 1,775 records

3 Main findings

3.1 Overall sanitary inspection outcomes

Most inspections were favorable: 66,815 records (93.68%) were classified as “Satisfaisant” or “Très satisfaisant”. The remaining 4,510 (6.32%) required improvement or urgent correction. This is a share of recorded inspections, not a national estimate of unsafe establishments.

3.2 The type of establishment matters, but volume matters too

Restaurants account for 33,165 inspections, the largest activity group, with 2,194 unfavorable evaluations (6.62%). Bakeries and pastry shops recorded 728 unfavorable inspections out of 8,076 (9.01%); butcher shops recorded 251 out of 2,962 (8.47%). Comparing percentages alone can be misleading: group sizes and inspection selection may differ.

3.3 The strongest contrast: inspection context

Complaints and reports are associated with substantially higher observed unfavorable rates than scheduled or follow-up inspections. This does not show that complaints cause poor outcomes: complaint-driven controls may focus on establishments where problems are already suspected.

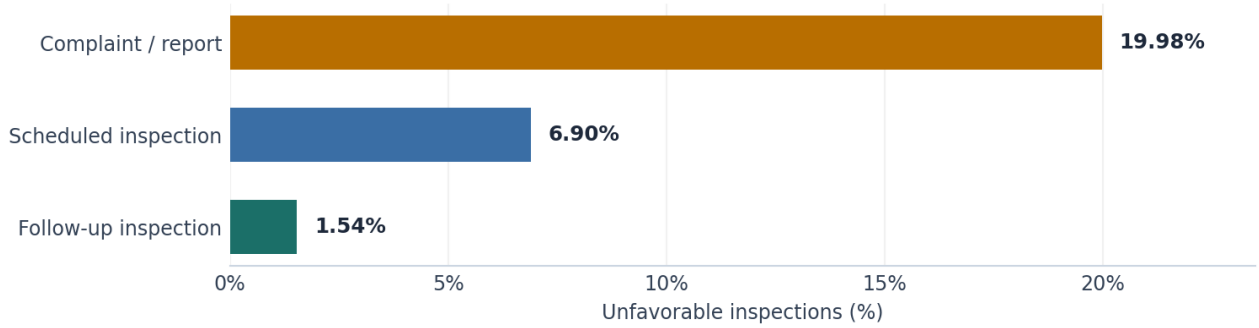


Figure 1. Unfavorable shares among recorded inspections. Complaint/report: 222 of 1,111; scheduled: 3,673 of 53,227; follow-up: 215 of 13,989. Source: Alim’confiance snapshot.

3.4 Geography and time require contextual interpretation

Regional differences can be large, but some groups are small. For example, Mayotte recorded 40 unfavorable results out of 112 inspections (35.71%), while Guadeloupe recorded 64 out of 247 (25.91%). These should not be interpreted as rankings of regional food safety. The dashboard uses a minimum of 100 inspections for its rate rankings.

Across complete months, the observed unfavorable rate rises from 2.67% in November 2025 to 15.47% in September 2026. The two October months are incomplete and excluded from the complete-month rate comparison. Inspection targeting, the roughly one-year publication window and reporting delays mean that this pattern alone cannot demonstrate deteriorating food safety.

4 Meaning and implications

The main lesson is that an unfavorable inspection rate measures how often inspectors found problems in the places they inspected. It is not a direct probability that a randomly selected restaurant or shop is unsafe. The context of the inspection is particularly important when comparing activities, regions or time periods.

For responsible interpretation, comparisons should first be made among inspections with similar contexts and sufficient sample sizes. Future analysis could incorporate earlier snapshots to test apparent time trends and statistical models to separate associations between activity, inspection context and region.

5 Data quality and limitations

Selection bias. Inspections are not a random sample of all food businesses; some follow complaints, investigations or previous findings.

Unit of observation. Each row is an inspection, not a unique establishment, so a business can be counted more than once.

Geographic coverage. 1,738 records lack usable coordinates and do not appear on the map; 1,775 have an unknown region and are omitted from regional comparisons while remaining in national totals.

Time and reporting. The public dataset covers approximately one year. The first and last months are incomplete, and reporting delays may affect the most recent observations.

Interpretation and ethics. Differences are descriptive, not causal. The dashboard favors aggregate comparisons over rankings of individual establishments.

6 Dashboard design and reproducibility

The Streamlit dashboard provides four sidebar filters (region, activity, inspection context and inspection dates), a metric selector, three responsive KPIs, seven interactive Plotly visualizations, reference lines, a map and a data-quality chapter. Chart descriptions improve readability. Up to 5,000 map points are sampled using a fixed seed (42).

The submitted project includes the raw and cleaned CSV files, a notebook documenting exploration and cleaning decisions, and a reusable Python pipeline. From the app directory, the commands below allow another person to run the application and verify that cleaning reproduces the committed data:

```
python -m pip install -r requirements.txt
python scripts/check_clean.py
python -m streamlit run app.py
```

The project pins Streamlit 1.66.1, pandas 3.0.2 and Plotly 7.1.0. The build script can also retrieve newer source data with caching, but such downloads may produce different inspection counts; the included October 2026 snapshot is the reference for the findings in this report.

Conclusion

France’s published sanitary inspections mostly received favorable evaluations in this snapshot. However, observed outcomes vary markedly depending on where, when and why inspectors looked. The dashboard is designed to make those differences visible without confusing inspection records with a representative measure of national food safety.

References

French Ministry of Agriculture. Alim’confiance — “Résultats des contrôles officiels sanitaires — dispositif d’information Alim’confiance”. data.gouv.fr, extraction dated 22 October 2026. Licence Ouverte / Open Licence.

https://www.data.gouv.fr/datasets/resultats-des-controles-officiels-sanitaires-dispositif-dinformation-alimconfiance